THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE • NURSERY – CLASS XII • JAIPUR

Road No. 5, VKIA, Jaipur — 9887258679

CLASS 8 ENGLISH — READING SKILL PAPER SET 07

Reading Comprehension | RBSE Board Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 40 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 20**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Section A has one factual passage with 10 questions (1 mark each).
3. Section B has one literary passage (poem or story) with 10 questions (1 mark each).
4. Write the question number before each answer.

SECTION — A (Reading Comprehension: Factual / Discursive Passage) 10 Marks

Read the passage and answer the questions.

1. *Read the passage carefully and answer the questions that follow.* 10

Reaching for the Moon

For centuries, people looked at the Moon and wondered what lay on its surface. Only in the twentieth century did they find a way to reach it. In 1969 two astronauts from the United States walked on the Moon, and since then, scientists in several countries have sent spacecraft to study it. India's own lunar missions began with Chandrayaan-1 in 2008, which discovered signs of water molecules on the Moon. Later missions explored the south polar region, which no country had visited before.

A lunar mission is one of the hardest tasks in engineering. The rocket must escape the pull of the Earth, travel nearly four lakh kilometres and slow down at exactly the right moment to land gently. There is no air on the Moon to help a parachute work, so the spacecraft must use small rockets to control its descent. A mistake of a few seconds can mean failure, which is why scientists test every part again and again on the ground.

Space missions give us more than pictures. The technology developed for them has helped in daily life: satellites help us forecast the weather and use maps on our phones; light and strong materials are used in sports goods; and medical instruments have been improved. Space research also makes young people curious about science, and many of today's students dream of becoming scientists and astronauts.

Some critics argue that a poor country should spend money on hospitals and schools rather than on rockets. Supporters answer that the money spent on space is a small part of the budget, and that the knowledge and jobs it creates return many times over. Whatever the view, there is no doubt that the sight of a rocket rising into the sky fills a nation with pride and hope.

(i) India's first lunar mission was: 1

(a) Chandrayaan-3 **(b)** Aryabhata

(c) Mangalyaan **(d)** Chandrayaan-1

(ii) A lunar landing is difficult because: 1

(a) rockets are slow **(b)** the Moon is too bright

(c) there is no air to help a parachute work **(d)** the Moon is hot

(iii) Which is a daily-life benefit of space technology mentioned? 1

(a) cheaper fuel **(b)** free travel

(c) weather forecasts **(d)** taller buildings

(iv) The word 'descent' in paragraph 2 means: 1

(a) coming down **(b)** going up

(c) standing still **(d)** moving sideways

(v) Critics say that poor countries should spend money on: 1

(a) bigger rockets **(b)** films
(c) sports **(d)** hospitals and schools

(vi) State whether True or False: Chandrayaan-1 found signs of water molecules on the Moon. Correct if false. 1

(vii) Why do scientists test every part again and again? 1

(viii) How far is the Moon from the Earth, according to the passage? 1

(ix) What is the reply of those who support space missions? 1

(x) What did the Moon landing of 1969 achieve, according to the passage? 1

SECTION — B (Reading Comprehension: Literary Passage — Poem / Story) — 10 Marks

Read the text and answer the questions.

2. *Read the passage carefully and answer the questions that follow.* 10

The River's Song

I rise in the hills where the snowflakes sleep,
A trickle, a whisper, a tiny leap;
I wind through the pines and the mossy stone,
Singing a tune that is all my own.

I turn the wheel of the village mill,
I carry the boats down the sloping hill;
I water the fields where the wheat stands tall,
And I give to the thirsty the gift of all.

Some build their houses beside my shore,
Some cast their nets and fish for more;
Some wash their clothes and some their sins,
And I take it all, as the day begins.

Yet I am tired of the plastic and waste
That people pour in with careless haste;
I ask for nothing but water clear
That my children, the fish, may live without fear.

And when I reach the open sea,
I join the waves that are wild and free;
But do not forget, as you walk the strand—
I began as a drop in a mountain land.

(i) The river begins: 1

(a) in the sea **(b)** in the desert
(c) in a pond **(d)** in the hills

(ii) The river turns the wheel of the: 1

(a) clock **(b)** village mill **(c)** bicycle **(d)** car

(iii) The river is tired of: 1

(a) snow **(b)** fishermen
(c) plastic and waste **(d)** boats

(iv) The poet says 'my children, the fish' because: 1

(a) the river is speaking as a mother and personifies itself **(b)** fish eat the river
(c) the fish are small **(d)** the river is a person

(v) The message of the poem is: 1

(a) avoid the sea
(b) travel more
(c) keep rivers clean
(d) build more mills

(vi) What is the river's 'tune'? 1

(vii) Name two ways in which people use the river. 1

(viii) What does the river ask of people? 1

(ix) Pick out a pair of rhyming words from the first stanza. 1

(x) What do you think the 'gift of all' is? 1

END OF QUESTION PAPER **Total: 20 Marks**

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